

USER'S MANUAL

121 Group Project Management Tool

Get productive in your first hour. Find your way around. Build the habits that make the tool actually work.

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Prepared by Nikko Trinidad

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Welcome

Hi! Welcome to the 121 Group Project Management Tool.

This is the system the agency runs on. Every client, every service, every task you'll work on lives here. The point of this tool isn't to add work to your day. The point is to make the work you already do faster, clearer, and easier to share.

Think of it like a kitchen with stations. Each station has a job: client info lives in one spot, service kanbans in another, the weekly sync in a third. You walk to the station you need, do the work, and move on. No hunting for sticky notes, no asking three people where something is.

This manual has three parts:

A Quick Start that gets you productive in your first hour.

Eight workflow chapters covering the things you'll actually do day to day, the way you'd actually do them.

A feature reference at the back that walks every page of the tool, field by field, in case you need to look something up later.

If you're brand new, read the Quick Start, skim the workflows for the ones you'll use, and bookmark the reference. If you've used the tool for a while, jump to whichever workflow you're stuck on.

Let me know if anything in here is confusing or wrong. The doc is a living thing.

Nikko

Quick Start: Your first hour

What you'll learn in the next hour

By the end of this Quick Start you'll know how to find your way around, work a single client end to end, and know what to do when things get stuck. We'll go through 10 short steps. Each one is small enough to do in a couple of minutes. The whole walkthrough should take under an hour.

Step 1: Sign in and land on Home

Open the URL your manager shared. Click Sign in with Google. Pick your @121group.io account. After a moment you land on the Home page.

Home shows three things at the top: today's date, a greeting, and a one-line summary of how your morning looks. Below that, Portfolio Health splits all your clients into ON FIRE / AT RISK / ON TRACK. If something's red, that's where you go first.

Step 2: Read your MY TASKS feed

Below Portfolio Health, MY TASKS lists every on-fire client that needs you right now. Each row is a client, not a task. Acme Corporation, Cobalt Auto, Orbit Esports, that kind of thing.

Each row tells you: how many cards are overdue, how many are blocked, what's blocking them, and how late the worst one is. Two buttons sit on the right of every row: Delegate (hand it off) and Review (open the work yourself).

Don't try to fix everything at once. Pick the most overdue row. Click Review.

Step 3: Find your way around a client's kanban board

Review takes you to that client's kanban for the service that needs attention. The board has five columns: To Do, In Progress, Blocked, Needs Review, Done. Each card represents a task. The columns mean exactly what they say.

If a card has a colored stripe on the left, that's the priority signal. Red is high priority. Faint grey is medium. If the right edge of the card has a date pill, that's when the work is due. If a date pill is red, the work is overdue.

Don't move cards yet. Just look. Get a sense of where the work sits.

Step 4: Open a card and read it

Click on any card. The card modal opens. The modal has two sides: details on the left, conversation on the right.

Left side: status, priority, who owns it, how much effort it'll take (in slots, more on that later), due date, start date, whether the work repeats, labels, description, checklist.

Right side: comments and activity log. Comments are what your team has said. Activity log is what the system tracked (card moved to In Progress, due date changed, etc.).

Read the description. Read the most recent comment. Now you know what the work is and where it stands.

Step 5: Move the card forward

Two ways to move a card. Drag it to the next column with your mouse, or click the Status field inside the card modal and pick a new status. Either works.

If the work is yours, drag it to In Progress. If you finished it, drag it to Needs Review (someone else looks at it before Done) or straight to Done if it's a card that doesn't need review.

If the work is blocked on something or someone, drag it to Blocked. When you do this, leave a comment explaining what the blocker is. Future-you will thank you.

Step 6: Comment, don't email

When you have a question or update on a card, comment on the card. Don't email. Don't Slack. Don't text. Comments stay with the work.

Comments support @-mentions. Type @ and a name to ping a teammate. They'll see it in their notifications bell at the top right.

This is the single biggest habit that makes this tool work. If we all comment in one place, nobody has to chase anyone for context. If we scatter the conversation across Slack and email, the tool stops being useful and we're back to chaos.

Step 7: Star a board you'll use a lot

Close the card modal (Escape, the X, or click outside). On the kanban header, click the star icon next to the breadcrumb. That pins the board to your Home page.

Now go back to Home. Scroll down past MY TASKS, past the weekly schedule. You'll see MY BOARDS. The board you just starred is in there. From now on, you can jump to that board with one click from Home.

Step 8: Check who's free this week

Go to the Ops page (top nav). Click the Team Capacity tab. You'll see a heatmap of the team for the next two weeks.

Every row is a teammate. Every column is a workday. Each cell shows how many slots they're booked for vs. their soft cap. Green means under-booked, amber means stretching, red means over the limit.

If you need to delegate something, this view tells you who has room. Click any cell to see what's specifically stacked on that person that day.

Step 9: Prep for the weekly meeting

Go to the Weekly WIP page. This is where the team prepares for the Monday sync. Two tabs: Agenda and Live meeting.

Agenda is what the team will discuss. It auto-populates from live data: New clients (clients added in the last few weeks), Top priority (what's on fire), On track (work that's progressing fine), and Added by hand (anything someone manually added).

If you have something you want to discuss, click + Add agenda item before Monday. It'll show up in the Added by hand section.

Step 10: Find your settings

Click your avatar at the top right. The dropdown shows your identity, an Account settings link, the theme toggle, and Sign out.

Click Account settings. The modal opens with three groups in the sidebar: My account (Profile, Preferences, Notifications, Time off), Workspace (Members, Job titles, Holidays, Trash), and Account (Sign-in).

Worth doing in your first hour: set your time zone in Profile, pick your time format (12-hour or 24-hour) in Preferences, and check what notifications you want. The rest you'll discover as you go.

That's the tour. Below are the workflows you'll do day to day. Pick whichever one you're about to actually do, and start there.

Workflows

Eight chapters covering the things you'll actually do day to day, the way you'd actually do them. Pick whichever applies to what you're trying to do right now.

Onboarding a new client

When the agency signs a new client, somebody (usually an Account Manager or Operations Manager) sets them up in the tool. The setup creates the client record, their services, their onboarding checklist, and the team that owns them. Done right, this is a 15-minute job. Done wrong, the client floats half-set-up for weeks while everyone wonders who owns what.

Before you start

You need a few things: the client's company name, their industry, their website, the primary contact's details (name, role, email, mobile), and the services they signed up for (web design, SEO retainer, brand refresh, whatever it is).

If you're missing the contact details, get them before you start. Half-filling a client record and promising to come back later is how things slip.

Step 1: Add the client

Go to Clients (top nav). On the left pane click + Add client. The Add client modal opens.

Fill in: Client name, Industry (pick from the dropdown), Website, Account Manager (the AM who owns the relationship), Status (almost always Onboarding (first 30 days) for a new client).

In the Primary contact section: contact name, position, email, mobile. If they have multiple contacts, use + Add another contact.

Click Create client. The client now lives in the list.

Step 2: Add their services

Click on the client you just created. The detail pane opens. You'll see the Overview tab is active. There's an ACTIVE SERVICES section with an Edit + Add service button on the right.

Click + Add service. The Add service modal opens. Fill in: Service name (e.g., 'Brand Refresh Q2'), Type (Retainer for ongoing work, Project for one-shot), Template (pick the right template for this kind of work — that pre-loads the kanban with the right phases and tasks), Next deliverable (the date of their first milestone).

Click Create service. The service now lives under the client. Repeat for every service the client signed up for.

Heads up: picking the right template matters. Choosing Web Design Full Stack for an SEO Retainer client doesn't break anything, but you'll spend the next month deleting irrelevant tasks. Pick well at setup.

Step 3: Walk the onboarding checklist

Click the Onboarding tab on the client detail. Each service you added has its own onboarding section split into FROM CLIENT (things you need from them) and FROM US (things we set up).

Read both sides. If you've already collected something from the client (their brand assets, their domain credentials, whatever), tick the box. If you haven't, leave it for now and chase it later.

Best practice: send the client a single message with everything in the FROM CLIENT side, all at once. Don't drip-request. New clients are most willing to send stuff in week one. Use that window.

Step 4: Assign the team

Click the About tab. There's a Project Team section. Click Edit. Add the people who will work on this client: the AM, the strategist, the designer, the developer, whoever's involved. Pick from the workspace members list.

Why this matters: when you assign team members here, tasks for this client default to those people in the kanban assignee picker. Saves time later. Also lets the team see at a glance who their teammates are on this client.

Step 5: Mark them ON TRACK once setup is done

Once the onboarding checklist is fully ticked and the team is assigned, change the client's Status from 'Onboarding (first 30 days)' to 'On track'. You can do this from the client detail header (status pill is click-to-edit).

This is what makes the client disappear from the Onboarding bucket on the Clients filter and show up in On track. It's also what triggers the analytics to start counting them as an active client.

TL;DR: 5 steps. Add client. Add services with the right templates. Walk the onboarding checklist. Assign the team. Mark on track when setup is done.

Running your service kanban day to day

This is the work most people do most days. You open a client's kanban, look at where the work sits, move cards forward, leave comments, close out tasks. Nothing fancy. Just consistent rhythm.

Open the board you need

Three ways. (1) From Home, click a starred board under MY BOARDS. (2) From Home, click Review on a MY TASKS row. (3) From Clients, click a client, then click the service. Whichever is fastest from where you are.

Read before you act

Before you move anything, scan the columns. To Do is the queue. In Progress is what's happening right now. Blocked is stuck. Needs Review is waiting on a teammate. Done is shipped.

If In Progress has more than 4-5 cards for one person, that person is overcommitted. Either help them or push something back to To Do. Work in progress costs more than work in queue.

Filter to what's yours

If the board has a lot of cards, filter. The filter bar at the top has Search, Assignee, Labels, Priority, and Due date pickers. Pick yourself in Assignee to see only your work.

If the board has labels, those are usually swimlanes for different work types (e.g., 'Email', 'Display', 'Search'). Filter by label to focus.

Use Group to slice differently

Sort: Manual is the default. If you want to see everything by priority instead, change Group to Priority. The columns then break into priority swimlanes inside each column. Useful for triage.

Group by Assignee is useful when you're running a 1:1 with a teammate and want to walk through their work without filtering everyone else out.

Add a card the right way

+ Add Card lives only in the To Do column. Click it. Type the title. Hit Enter. Done.

Don't fill in everything at once. Title is enough to create the card. You can add details (assignee, due date, description, checklist) by clicking the card to open the modal afterward.

Why only To Do? Because cards should enter the system at the top of the funnel. If you create a card directly in In Progress, you skipped the planning step. If you create it in Done, you're back-dating work that didn't go through the system. Both bad habits.

Move cards as work moves

When you start working on a card, drag it to In Progress. When you finish, drag it to Needs Review or Done. When you can't proceed, drag it to Blocked.

Always leave a comment when you change status to Blocked. Even one line: 'Waiting on client to send logo.' Without that, the next person looking at the board has no idea what to do.

If a card sits in Needs Review for more than a couple of days, ping the reviewer. Reviews don't review themselves.

Use the kebab menu for housekeeping

Each card has a kebab (■) menu. Open it for Duplicate, Copy link, Archive, Delete. Duplicate is useful for recurring-style cards. Copy link gives you a deep-link you can paste in a comment elsewhere. Archive moves the card off the board but keeps it for restore. Delete soft-deletes (90-day grace) before permanent removal.

Pin a card for the next WIP

If you want to discuss a card at the next Weekly WIP, click the bookmark icon on the card modal toolbar. That pins it to the WIP agenda for Monday. The agenda's Top priority section will pick it up.

Pinning is the fastest way to get something on the team's radar without sending a message.

Running the Weekly WIP meeting

Every Monday at 10am the team meets. Before this tool existed, that meeting was 30 minutes of someone reading a spreadsheet out loud. Now the agenda auto-builds from live data. The point of the meeting is to align on the week, not to recite status.

Friday afternoon: prep

Around end-of-day Friday, open Weekly WIP. The Agenda tab shows what Monday's discussion will cover.

Read each section. New clients (people who joined this past week or two), Top priority (what's on fire), On track (work that's progressing as expected), Added by hand (one-off items someone manually added).

If something's missing — a topic you want raised, a decision you need from leadership — click + Add agenda item. Write a clear title. It'll show up under Added by hand.

If you want a teammate to know they're on the hook to speak, mention them in the agenda item description.

Send the pre-read

Once the agenda looks right, click Send pre-read. The team gets a link to the Monday agenda so nobody walks in cold. Doing this on Friday gives people the weekend to scan if they want to. Doing it Monday morning at 9:55 doesn't help anyone.

Monday: run the meeting

When the meeting starts, click Live meeting. The view switches to a per-item walkthrough. Each agenda item becomes a focus card. The team works through them in order. Items can be marked complete, deferred, or kicked over to the next week.

Estimated minutes is a rough guide. 14 items at ~2 minutes each is ~28 minutes. If you blow past that, you're spending too long on individual items. Park the deeper conversation, take it offline, move on.

After the meeting

When the meeting wraps, click Start meeting (or End meeting if it's running). The decisions get captured against each item. Anything that needs follow-up gets a card created automatically and assigned to the right person.

TL;DR for the WIP: prep Friday, send pre-read, run Live meeting Monday. Don't read agenda items aloud during the meeting if everyone's already read them. Discuss only the things that need group decision.

Setting up recurring tasks

Some work happens on a schedule. Weekly status reports, monthly retainer check-ins, quarterly planning. Instead of remembering to create those cards by hand every time, you set the recurrence rule once and the system spawns the next instance automatically when you complete the current one.

Open the card you want to recur

Open any card on a service kanban or the Ops board. Inside the card modal, look for the Repeat field — it sits between Start date and Labels.

By default the field reads 'Doesn't repeat'. Click the field. A small popover opens.

Pick a preset or build a custom rule

The popover offers five presets: Daily, Weekly on , Monthly on the , Yearly, and Custom...

If your rule fits a preset, click it. The rule applies immediately. Done.

If your rule is more specific (every 2 weeks on Mon and Wed and Fri, for example), click Custom. The popover expands to show controls: Every , plus an 'On' row that adapts to the pattern (day-of-week chips for weekly, day-of-month input for monthly).

Build the rule, watch the summary line at the top of the field update as you change things. The summary should read like a sentence: 'Every 2 weeks on Mon, Wed, Fri'.

Add an end date or pause if needed

Below the presets there are two toggles: End by and Pause.

End by lets you set a date the rule stops. Useful for: 'Run this weekly until end of Q2, then stop.' Default is 3 months from today, but you can change it.

Pause keeps the rule attached but stops new spawns. Useful for: 'We're skipping this week's status report because the client is on holiday, but we'll resume next week.' Toggle Pause on, the recurrence stays put but doesn't fire. Toggle Pause off when you want it to resume.

How the spawn works

When you complete a recurring card (drag it to Done), the system immediately creates a new copy in To Do with the next computed due date. The new card has the same title, description, labels, priority, assignee, and slot count. Comments and activity stay on the old card as history.

If you've set an End by date and the next due date would be after it, no new card spawns. The series ends naturally.

Heads up: if you duplicate a recurring card manually (via the kebab menu), the duplicate doesn't carry the recurrence rule. Manual duplication is for one-offs. The rule lives only on the original series.

TL;DR for recurring: open card, click Repeat field, pick preset or build custom, optional End by and Pause toggles. Move the card to Done to spawn the next one.

Time off requests and approvals

Time off lives in the tool so coverage planning, rule-based conflict checks, and approval flows all happen in one place. No more Slack-then-email-then-calendar dance. Submit, approve, done.

Submit a request (any team member)

Click your avatar at top right, Account settings, Time off. You see your status sections (Pending review, Approved, Denied, Past) and a Request time off CTA at the top.

Click Request time off. The modal opens. Pick start and end dates. Optionally write a reason. If you have a transfer credit available (earned by working a holiday you would have otherwise observed), you can tick 'Use 1 holiday transfer credit' to spend it on this request.

Click Submit. The request lands in the approver's queue. You'll see it in your Pending review section with the date you submitted.

What happens next

Owner or Admin gets a notification in their bell. They open the Approvals queue (Ops > Time off Schedules > right rail Approvals tab) and see your request along with any conflicts.

Conflicts come from coverage rules — like 'always need 1 Account Manager present' or 'no more than 2 designers off at once'. If your request would break a rule, the approver sees the violation inline and decides whether to approve anyway or deny.

When the approver decides, you get a notification with their decision. Approved lands in your Approved section. Denied stays visible (with the approver's note if they left one) so you have the audit trail.

Approve or deny (Owner or Admin only)

Open Ops > Time off Schedules. The right rail has three sub-tabs: Approvals, Rules, Conflicts.

Approvals shows pending requests. Each row has the requester, dates, reason, and any conflict warnings. Click into a request to see the full breakdown: who else is off on those dates, what coverage rules would break, what holidays fall in the window.

Two buttons: Approve or Deny. If you Deny, leave a decision note explaining why. The requester sees the note. Without context, denial feels arbitrary.

Edit coverage rules

Same right rail, Rules sub-tab. List of every rule the workspace has. Click a rule to edit. The editor lets you set who the rule applies to (a job-title group like 'Account Managers', a role group like 'Admins', or specific members), the constraint ('at least N present' or 'at most N out'), and when it fires (weekdays only, or every day).

+ New rule at the top adds a new one. Rules stay active until archived. Archived rules don't affect approvals but stay in the audit trail.

Holidays and observation overrides

When a holiday falls in someone's calendar, they observe it by default — meaning they're considered off without needing to submit a request.

If someone works through a holiday they would normally observe (sometimes a designer fills in for a critical launch), an Owner or Admin flips their status in the day popover (click the day in the calendar). They earn a transfer credit they can spend on a future request.

TL;DR for time off: requester submits, approver decides, decision note matters, coverage rules and holidays do the conflict math automatically.

Using and editing templates

Templates are reusable scaffolds for services. Pick a template when you create a new service and the kanban comes pre-seeded with the right phases and example tasks. The template also defines the onboarding checklist that shows up on the client detail. Get the templates right and onboarding is a 15-minute job.

Open Templates

Top nav, click Templates. Two-pane layout. Left pane is the list of templates. Right pane is the detail for the selected template.

Each template in the list shows: name, kind pill (Brand, Content, Web Development, etc.), and a summary line ('6 phases · 6 onboarding items').

Anatomy of a template

Click any template. The detail pane shows: header (name + kind pill + click-to-edit hint), Phases section, Onboarding checklist section.

Phases are the columns of work the template seeds into the kanban. A Brand Refresh template might have Discovery, Moodboards, Logo concepts, System design, Guidelines, Rollout kit. Each phase becomes a column of starter tasks when a service is created from this template.

Onboarding checklist is the FROM CLIENT / FROM US split that lands on the client detail when a service from this template is added. FROM CLIENT is what we need to ask for. FROM US is what we set up internally.

Edit an existing template

Every field on the template is click-to-edit. Click the name to rename. Click a phase to rename it or change its subtask count. Drag a phase by the handle on the left to reorder. Click a checklist item to rename or remove it. + Add phase at the bottom of the phases list. + Add item under each onboarding section.

Built-in templates have a RESET TO DEFAULT button in the header. If you accidentally edit a built-in template into nonsense, RESET pulls it back to the factory version. User-created templates don't have this — there's nothing to reset to.

Create a new template

+ New template at the top of the list. Name it, pick a kind, fill in the phases and onboarding items. Save.

Best practice: build templates from real services. When the agency lands a new kind of work and you set up the first one by hand, take note of what phases worked. Build the template from that, so the second client of that type takes 15 minutes instead of 90.

TL;DR for templates: they're scaffolds. Pick the right one when adding a service. Edit them as the agency learns. Reset built-ins if you break them.

Reading the Analytics dashboard

Analytics is for the operator who walks in Monday and asks 'what should I look at first?' It's not for executive reports or board decks. It surfaces the live state of the agency's delivery so you can move fast on the things that need attention.

Top of page: filters and KPIs

Three filter pills at the top: Anyone (filter by assignee), All projects (filter to a specific service), and the date window ('Overdue + next 30 days' by default).

Below the filters, four KPI cards: ON-TIME RATE, BLOCKED NOW, DUE NEXT 7 DAYS, CLIENTS FLAGGED. Each one is a number with a foot text giving more context ('310 closed in window · 231 on time').

What each KPI means

ON-TIME RATE: the percent of recently-closed tasks that landed on or before their due date. Lower than expected? Either due dates were too aggressive or the team is overloaded.

BLOCKED NOW: how many open tasks are stuck. The foot text shows the oldest blocker's age. If something's been blocked a week, it deserves attention before newer blockers.

DUE NEXT 7 DAYS: how much work has a hard deadline in the next week. The foot text shows how many are already overdue. This is the 'what do we need to ship soon' number.

CLIENTS FLAGGED: clients in fire or risk status. Foot text lists the first three by name.

Click a KPI for the drill-down

Each KPI card is clickable. Click it and a drill panel opens below the cards listing the rows behind the number. On-time rate drill shows closed tasks sorted late-first. Blocked now drill shows blocked tasks oldest-first. Due next 7 days drill shows open tasks with deadlines in the window.

Click any row in a drill to jump straight to that task or client.

Upcoming deliverables

Below the KPI grid, the Upcoming deliverables section lists every task with a due date in the active window. Three sub-tabs: Today, This week, Next week. Each row shows overdue indicator, day-of-week, title, client/service, assignee, status pill, and a chevron to open.

If you're triaging the day, this is the section you live in. Sort by due date, knock down the overdues first.

Team workload

At the bottom, Team workload shows every team member with a horizontal bar showing their share of open work. Bar length is relative to the busiest teammate, not absolute capacity (we don't track hours, so the bar is card count not time).

Useful for spotting load imbalances. If one person has 589 open tasks and the next has 283, the first person needs help.

TL;DR for analytics: KPIs at the top tell you what's hot. Drills tell you which rows are behind the number. Upcoming deliverables is the daily punch list. Team workload is the load-balance view.

Managing your profile and the workspace

Your settings live in the avatar dropdown at top right. The modal that opens has three groups: My account (you), Workspace (team-wide settings, Owner and Admin only), and Account (sign-in stuff).

Profile

Set your full name, preferred name, avatar color, role/title, and time zone. Email is locked because it's managed by Google.

Preferred name shows up in casual contexts ('Hi Mark') while Full name shows in formal ones (member list, audit logs). Time zone is what your schedule and due dates render in.

Preferences

Two settings here. Appearance lets you pick Light, Dark, or System theme. Time format is 12-hour or 24-hour. The theme toggle is also reachable in one click from the avatar dropdown.

Notifications

Toggle which notifications you want. Urgent (overdue tasks, due-today, on-fire clients) and digest (daily summary) are the two main switches. Per-category preferences below let you tune further.

Time off (your own)

Where you submit time off requests and see their status. Covered in detail in the Time off chapter earlier.

Workspace settings (Owner and Admin only)

Members: list of everyone with workspace access. Add by sending an invite link with a pre-assigned role. Remove members here. Change member roles (Owner > Admin > Member > Viewer).

Job titles: catalog of titles available across the workspace. Add new ones, archive old ones, assign them to members.

Holidays: country-filtered list of holidays. PH and AU pre-seeded. Edit observation defaults per holiday. Set the credit-expiry policy (end-of-year, 6 months, 12 months, or never).

Trash: 90-day soft-delete bin. Restore or purge deleted items here. Empty Trash if you're sure.

Sign-in

Active session list. Sign out of any individual session, or Sign out everywhere if you suspect unauthorized access.

TL;DR: Profile + Preferences are the two sections every employee should fill in on day one. The rest is admin housekeeping.

Feature reference

Every page of the tool, walked field by field. Use this as a lookup when you're stuck on a specific surface and want to know what each control does.

TopNav

The chrome at the top of every page. Logo and nav links on the left, search and avatar on the right.

Logo / wordmark

Top-left. Clicking takes you to Home.

Nav links

Home / Clients / Ops / Analytics / Weekly WIP / Templates. Click any to switch surfaces. The active link gets a blue tint background.

Search field

Right side. Click or press K (Mac) / Ctrl+K (Windows). Searches across clients, tasks, people.

Notifications bell

Click to open the notifications panel. Unread count shows as a badge.

Avatar

Click for the dropdown: identity block, Account settings, theme toggle, Sign out.

Home page

The landing page. Designed to answer 'what should I do first?' in 5 seconds.

Date eyebrow + greeting

Today's date and a contextual greeting (Good morning / afternoon / evening + your name).

Subtitle

One-line summary of how your day looks: 'X clients need you now.'

Portfolio Health card

Three KPIs side by side: ON FIRE (clients needing immediate attention), AT RISK (clients in concerning state), ON TRACK (clients doing fine). Click any to filter the Clients page to that bucket.

MY TASKS section

On-fire clients listed as cards. Each card: ON FIRE pill, client name, aggregate count ('X overdue · Y blocked'), blocking-reason caption, X days overdue stamp, Delegate + Review buttons.

View all N tasks link

Below the visible cards. Click to expand the full list inline.

MY SCHEDULE section

5-day week grid. Each day shows date, day name, and your task count for the day (e.g., '0/6'). Tabs at the top toggle This week / Next week. Each day card has a kebab menu for per-day actions.

MY BOARDS section

Your favorited service boards. Star a board from the kanban header to pin it here. Empty state has a 'Browse clients' link.

Clients page

The directory of every client the agency works with.

Header eyebrow

ALL QUIET TODAY (changes contextually). h1 'Clients'. Subtitle 'Every client you work with, in one place.'

Search + count + Add

Search clients input with magnifying glass. Count badge shows total clients. + Add client CTA opens the Add client modal.

Filter chips

Bucket filters: All / Assigned to me / On Fire / At Risk / On Track / Onboarding / Paused / Archived. Click any to filter the list. Counts in chips reflect the data.

Client list rows

Each row: status dot, avatar, client name, industry/domain, service tag chips, last activity timestamp on the right.

Detail pane (right side)

Opens when you click a client. Header card with avatar, name, status pill, industry, manager, client-since date, kebab menu. Tabs below: Overview, Onboarding, About, Stats, Notes.

Overview tab

NEEDS ATTENTION block (past-due cards + at-risk surfaces), then ACTIVE SERVICES list. Each service has health pill, template, due, progress bar.

Onboarding tab

Per-service checklist split into FROM CLIENT and FROM US. Tick items as they land.

About tab

Relationship section: Client Contacts, Quick Links, Project Team. Manage contact details and assign team members here.

Stats tab

Per-client analytics: task throughput, on-time rate, retention metrics.

Notes tab

Two-pane note editor with search. Empty state has + New note CTA.

Service kanban + card modal

The board where day-to-day work lives. Each kanban represents one service for one client.

Breadcrumb + star

Clients > Client > Service. Star icon next to the breadcrumb pins the board to MY BOARDS on Home.

Header buttons

Project Brief (read the brief), Board Settings (column config), Members (who has access), Analytics (jump to filtered analytics).

Filters bar

Search cards, Assignee, Labels, Priority, Due date. Group selector (None / Priority / Assignee / Labels) for swimlane views. Sort: Manual by default.

Columns

Five columns: TO DO, IN PROGRESS, BLOCKED, NEEDS REVIEW, DONE. Each column has a count and a kebab for column-level actions.

Card tile

Title, priority stripe (left edge), date pill (top-right), recurrence loop icon if recurring, assignee avatar (bottom-right). Done cards strike through.

+ Add Card

Only on the To Do column. Click to compose a new card inline.

Card modal — left side

Status, Priority, Assignees, Effort (slots), Due date, Start date, Repeat, Labels, Description, Checklist, Created/Due footer.

Card modal — right side

Comments and Activity Log tabs. Comment input with @-mentions. /Ctrl+Enter to send.

Card modal — toolbar

Top-right of the modal: Bookmark (pin to Weekly WIP), Share, Kebab (Duplicate, Copy link, Archive, Delete), Close.

Ops page

Internal team operations. Four tabs covering the team's own work, knowledge base, capacity heatmap, and time off calendar.

Header

INTERNAL WORK eyebrow + Ops h1 + 'The work the team does for itself.' subtitle. Right-aligned counts: tasks / in progress / blocked.

Tabs

Ops Board / Notes / Team Capacity / Time off Schedules.

Ops Board

Same kanban shape as service boards but for internal-only work. Five columns. + Add Card on To Do.

Notes

Two-pane note editor for team-wide knowledge. + New note at top right.

Team Capacity

10-day heatmap of slot load per teammate. Green/amber/red zones. Click a cell to see what's stacked on that person that day.

Time off Schedules

Calendar of approved time off. Right rail with Approvals, Rules, Conflicts sub-tabs. Filter chips for role and country.

Analytics page

Delivery health at a glance. KPIs, drill-downs, upcoming work, team workload.

Header

ANALYTICS eyebrow + 'Delivery health' h1 + 'Where to look when something feels off.' subtitle.

Filters

Anyone (assignee), All projects (service), date window (Overdue + next 7 / 30 / 90 / All time).

KPI cards (4)

ON-TIME RATE / BLOCKED NOW / DUE NEXT 7 DAYS / CLIENTS FLAGGED. Click any to open the drill-down panel below.

Drill-down panel

Lists the rows behind the clicked KPI. Sortable, scrollable, click to jump.

Upcoming deliverables

Today / This week / Next week sub-tabs with task lists. Each row: overdue indicator, title, subtitle, assignee, status pill.

Team workload

Member rows with relative-share bars and open task counts. Job titles in subtitle. Hover for chevron drill-down (member-specific tasks).

Weekly WIP page

Where the team prepares for and runs the Monday sync.

Header

WEEKLY WIP eyebrow + 'Prep the meeting' h1 + 'Your team's weekly sync, ready to run.' subtitle.
NEXT MEETING block on the right shows next sync date and time.

Tabs

Agenda (preview) / Live meeting (run mode).

Action bar

Items count + Add agenda item + Send pre-read + Start meeting (solid blue CTA).

Agenda sections

New clients, Top priority, On track, Added by hand. Each section auto-populates from live data except Added by hand which is manual.

Live meeting

Per-item walkthrough. Item card focus, timer per item, mark complete / defer / kick to next week.
Estimated minutes calculation.

Templates page

Reusable scaffolds for services.

Eyebrow + count

X ACTIVE · Y ARCHIVED split when archived templates exist. h1 'Templates'. Subtitle 'Reusable blueprints for every kind of work you do.'

Search + New template

Search templates input + New template CTA.

List rows (left pane)

Each row: icon, name, kind pill, summary line ('X phases · Y onboarding items').

Archived group

Collapsible group at the bottom of the list. Default-collapsed. Hides archived templates from the main list.

Detail pane (right)

Header (icon + name + kind pill + click-to-edit hint + USE TEMPLATE + RESET TO DEFAULT (built-ins only) + ARCHIVE). PHASES section with numbered phase rows + drag handles + Add phase. ONBOARDING CHECKLIST section with FROM CLIENT and FROM US sub-sections.

Account Settings

The big modal where personal and workspace settings live. Reached from the avatar dropdown.

Sidebar

Three groups: MY ACCOUNT (Profile, Preferences, Notifications, Time off), WORKSPACE (Workspace, Members, Job titles, Holidays, Trash), ACCOUNT (Sign-in).

Profile

Avatar color picker. Full name, preferred name, email (Google-managed), role/title, time zone.

Preferences

Appearance (Light/Dark/System) + Time format (12-hour / 24-hour).

Notifications

Urgent toggle + digest toggle + per-category preferences.

Time off

Submit requests, see their status, view transfer credits balance.

Workspace

Workspace name, initials, color, logo upload. Owner only.

Members

Search + member list with role pills + invite link generator. Owner and Admin.

Job titles

CRUD list of workspace titles.

Holidays

Country-filtered holiday list. Edit observation defaults. Credit-expiry policy radio.

Trash

90-day soft-delete bin. Restore or purge.

Sign-in

Active session list. Sign out everywhere.

Glossary

Terms used throughout the tool. Alphabetised so you can find them quickly.

Account Manager

The agency-side owner of a client relationship. Listed in the client detail header. Different from a 'manager' access role.

Activity Log

The right-pane tab on a card modal that shows every system-tracked event (status change, assignee change, etc.).

Archive

Soft-remove an item from active views without deleting it. Restorable from Trash within 90 days.

AT RISK

Client status. Things are concerning but not on fire yet. Rendered as orange in Portfolio Health.

Blocked

Kanban column. Cards that can't proceed because of an external dependency. Always leave a comment explaining the blocker.

Card

A single task on a kanban board. Has a title, status, assignee, priority, due date, etc.

Client

A company the agency works with. Has services, contacts, a project team, and a status.

Coverage rule

A constraint about who needs to be present on a given day. e.g., 'always need 1 Account Manager present'. Used by the time-off approver to flag conflicts.

Done

Kanban column. Cards that are complete. Rendered with strike-through titles.

Effort (slots)

How much capacity a card consumes. 1 slot = roughly half a day's focus. Used in the Team Capacity heatmap. Different from estimated hours.

In Progress

Kanban column. Cards being actively worked on right now. Limit yourself to 4-5 to avoid overcommitment.

Job title

Catalog-driven label for a team member's role (e.g., Account Manager, MLOps Engineer). Different from access role.

Kebab menu (■)

The three-dot menu icon used for secondary actions on cards, columns, and rows.

Needs Review

Kanban column. Cards waiting on a teammate's review before moving to Done.

ON FIRE

Client status. Needs immediate attention. Rendered as red. Shows up on Home in MY TASKS.

ON TRACK

Client status. Things are going as expected. Rendered as green.

Onboarding

(1) Client status during first 30 days. (2) The client-detail tab where setup tasks live.

Project

Service type. One-shot fixed deliverable (vs. retainer).

Recurrence rule

A repeat pattern set on a card. When the card moves to Done, a fresh copy spawns with the next due date.

Retainer

Service type. Ongoing monthly scope (vs. project).

Service

A specific engagement under a client (e.g., 'Brand Refresh Q2', 'SEO Retainer'). Each service has its own kanban.

Slot

Unit of effort capacity. See Effort.

Soft cap / Max cap

Per-member capacity thresholds. Soft cap is the comfortable max; max cap is the hard ceiling. Used in the Team Capacity heatmap.

Status pill

Color-coded label showing client or task state.

Swimlane

A horizontal grouping inside a kanban column. Created by changing the Group filter.

Template

Reusable scaffold for a service. Pre-loads phases and onboarding checklist when used.

To Do

Kanban column. Cards in the queue, not yet started. The only column where + Add Card lives.

Trash

90-day soft-delete bin. Lives in Account Settings > Workspace > Trash.

Transfer credit

A day off you earn by working through a holiday you would otherwise observe. Spendable on a future time-off request.

WIP

Work In Progress. Refers either to the kanban column or to the weekly meeting.

Workspace

The agency's tenant in the tool. One workspace per agency. All members belong to one workspace.

FAQ

Common questions, answered straight.

How do I get added to the workspace?

Your manager generates an invite link from Account Settings > Members and shares it with you. Sign in with your @121group.io Google account using that link.

I see a board I don't recognize. Why?

Either you've been added to the project team for that client, or the board was shared with you directly. Check the client detail About tab to see the team.

Why doesn't the search find my task?

Search looks across clients, tasks, and people. If your task title is generic (e.g., 'Test'), narrow your query. Search isn't fuzzy yet — exact-string matches first.

Why is my MY TASKS list empty?

Either you don't have any on-fire clients (great), or no clients have been assigned to you yet. Check the Clients page filter 'Assigned to me' to verify.

How do I delegate a task?

Click Delegate on the My Tasks card on Home. Or open the card modal and change the Assignee. Both work.

Where do I find a card I deleted by accident?

Account Settings > Workspace > Trash. Items stay for 90 days before permanent removal.

Why can't I edit something I expect to edit?

Likely a permissions issue. Owners and Admins can edit everything; Members can edit cards they're assigned to; Viewers can only read. Ping your Owner if you think your role is wrong.

What's the difference between Archive and Delete?

Archive removes from active views but keeps the item searchable and restorable. Delete sends to Trash (90-day grace) before permanent removal. Use Archive for finished work you might reference; Delete for mistakes.

Why did a recurring card not spawn?

Either the rule has an End by date that's passed, or Pause is on, or the card had no due date when you completed it (the system can't compute a next due without a previous one).

How do I see what someone else is working on?

Analytics > Team workload (open task counts) or Ops > Team Capacity (slot load by day). For a specific board, filter by Assignee.

My time off was denied. Now what?

Read the decision note from the approver. If you disagree or need to negotiate, reply via Slack or in person. Resubmit with adjusted dates if needed.

Can I work offline?

No. The tool needs an internet connection to sync. Drafts of comments and notes are saved locally so you don't lose them on a disconnect, but most actions require a live connection.

Why does dark mode look weird on dates?

Browser-side bug we're tracking. The native date picker doesn't fully adapt. Workaround: toggle to Light theme via Account settings > Preferences while editing dates.

Where can I report a bug?

Slack #pmt-feedback or directly to your Operations Manager. Include a screenshot if you can.

Troubleshooting

When things go wrong, here's where to look first.

Page won't load

Refresh first. If still broken, check your internet. If the page loads but data is missing, sign out (avatar > Sign out) and sign back in. If still broken, ping #pmt-feedback with the URL.

Sign-in loops back to the login screen

Your Google account isn't on the workspace. Ask your Owner to send you an invite link with the right role.

Can't see a client I expect to see

Check the Clients filter at the top. If 'Assigned to me' is on, switch to All. If All shows 0, your account doesn't have visibility — talk to your Owner.

A card I created disappeared

It was probably moved to a different column. Use search to find it by title. If it's in Trash, restore from Account Settings > Workspace > Trash.

Comments not posting

Check internet connection. The comment box should show a draft state. If posting silently fails, refresh the page — the draft is preserved.

Delegate or Review button doesn't open the right thing

Refresh the page once. If the button is dead even after refresh, screenshot it and post in #pmt-feedback.

Team Capacity heatmap shows wrong numbers

Either the team member's caps aren't set (Account Settings > Members > edit member), or tasks weren't assigned slots (open the card and set Effort). The math only counts cards with assigneeId set and slots > 0.

Time-off conflict warning I don't understand

Click the warning to see which coverage rule was triggered. The rule will say in plain English: 'Always need 1 Account Manager present on weekdays' or similar.

Last word: this manual is alive. If something's wrong, missing, or just plain confusing, tell us. The point is for it to help you do your job, not to be a museum piece.